Purposes and forms of remembrance

Tuesday 26 January 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | LAUNCH | Spring 1 Week 4 | HUM-LAUNCH-S1-W04

White paper version. Read quietly, point, write, type, speak privately or direct a scribe. You may pass. No public answer or reading aloud is required.

These six cards are new teaching explanations. They describe purposes and types of remembrance. No person’s testimony, story, words or image is reproduced, paraphrased or invented.

R1 Remembering the people

Purpose of remembrance

People who were persecuted and murdered had full lives, identities, interests, families and communities. Remembrance can honour those lives and the loss to people and communities. It helps us see people as individuals, not only as a number.

We can keep people’s dignity without inventing their words, feelings or life stories.

Think: Why does learning about lives matter as well as knowing a number?

R2 Learning from a warning

Purpose of remembrance

Careful study can show how prejudice, unfair rules and human choices caused harm. Remembering can help us recognise hatred and exclusion and question false claims. Events were not inevitable. People made decisions.

A warning invites learning and care. It does not mean that every present-day disagreement is the same as the Holocaust.

Think: How can learning about the past help people judge a claim today?

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R3 Responsibility today

Purpose of remembrance

Remembering can prompt us to learn accurately, treat people with dignity and check claims before sharing them. We can seek trusted adult help if we encounter antisemitism or targeted abuse. We do not have to confront someone or put ourselves at risk.

A ceremony alone cannot stop hatred. Responsibility continues beyond one day and is shared across society.

Think: Name a safe responsibility that follows from learning, without making a personal pledge.

R4 Memorial places and objects

One type of remembrance

A memorial may be a place or object set aside to remember people and events. Names or clear information can help people learn and reflect. Some memorials are used for gatherings; others allow private reflection. Their design and use differ.

A memorial needs context. One object cannot explain a whole history, and communities do not all remember in the same way.

Think: How could a memorial serve the purpose in R1? What else would help people learn?

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R5 A shared day of remembrance

One type of remembrance

Holocaust Memorial Day is marked in the UK on 27 January each year. It remembers those murdered in the Holocaust, other victims of Nazi persecution and people murdered in later genocides. It offers time to learn and reflect on prejudice and hatred today. Our lesson is on 26 January, the day before.

A shared day can create time for public or private remembrance. It does not require everyone to feel the same way or take part in one ritual. Learning can continue beyond that date.

Think: What is the national day for, and why is one day not enough on its own?

R6 Education and reflection

One type of remembrance

Lessons, talks, discussion and carefully checked historical records can help later generations learn. Education can explain people’s lives, decisions and the effects of persecution. It can help us challenge false claims and think about responsibility.

Learning needs accurate facts, context and care. Communities may use religious or non-religious forms of remembrance. Practices vary within communities as well as between them.

Think: How could education support more than one purpose of remembrance?